

Your Care Plan

Atrial Fibrillation

You are in the hospital for abnormal heartbeats (arrhythmias) in the upper heart chambers.

This handout gives you an idea of the stages you will go through on the way to getting better and leaving the hospital.

Many people can leave the hospital within 2 days after they are admitted. Other people need more time in the hospital. You may move through these steps faster or slower than shown here. You and your healthcare team will decide based on how you do each day.

Day 1



When You Enter the Hospital:

- You may be taken to the ICU (intensive care unit) or a regular hospital room depending on the type of care you need.



Your Activity:

- You may be able to get out of bed. Ask your doctor or nurse about this.



Your Food & Fluids:

- You may have an IV line for fluids and medicines.
- You should be able to drink fluids.
- You may be able to eat your usual foods.



Your Medicines:

- You may get one or more of these medicines:
 - Blood thinner
 - Medicine to control your heartbeat
 - Other medicines you normally take



Other Care:

- Your heartbeat may be watched on a monitor at the nurses' station.
- You may have a procedure to correct your heartbeat.
- You may have one or more tests that make pictures of what is happening inside your body. These may include:
 - Echo test (echocardiogram)

Day 2



Your Activity:

- You should be able to get up and move around more.



Your Food & Fluids:

- Your IV line may be removed today.
- You should be able to drink fluids.
- You may be able to eat your usual foods.



Your Medicines:

- You may get one or more of these medicines:
 - Blood thinner
 - Medicine to control your heartbeat
 - Other medicines you normally take



Other Care:

- You may get blood tests.
- Your heartbeat may continue to be watched on a monitor.
- Some of your medicines and activities may change because of your illness. Now is a good time to start learning about the changes you will need to make when you leave the hospital.

Day 3



Your Activity:

- You should be able to get up and move around more.



Your Food & Fluids:

- You should be able to drink fluids.
- You may be able to eat your usual foods.



Your Medicines:

- You may get one or more of these medicines:
 - Blood thinner
 - Medicine to control your heartbeat
 - Other medicines you normally take



Other Care:

- You may get blood tests.
- Your heartbeat may continue to be watched on a monitor.

Leaving the Hospital

- Most people are able to return home when they leave the hospital. Others move to a different type of healthcare setting to continue their recovery.
- You will be able to leave the hospital when:
 - Your test results are OK.
 - Your tests show that you did not have a heart attack.
 - Your heartbeat is OK.
 - Your blood pressure is OK.
 - You are not having trouble breathing.
 - You are able to think clearly.

- You are able to move around safely.
- When you leave the hospital you should have:
 - A list of all your medicines
 - Prescriptions for any new medicines you will need
 - A list of follow-up visits you will need
 - The information you need for your care at home
 - A plan for getting the care you need after you leave the hospital

This information is general in nature and may not apply to you or your condition. Talk to your doctor or nurse about how to best use this information and how to take care of your medical condition. Be sure to ask your doctor or nurse any questions you might have. This information sheet is not intended to provide or replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

Patient or Caregiver:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Nurse:

Signature: _____ Date: _____